Cost of Living At Low Ebb Here

Decrease Shown Since 1926

The cost of living ■ Shanghai now is the lowest recorded in eight years, according to a statement issued by the National Tariff Commission covering the period from 1926 until this spring.

The average index of cost during 1926 being set at 100, the index for March of this year (the last month covered) is 98.9, showing a decrease of 1.1. The maximum of the period was recorded in 1931, when the index figure was 125.9. Last March was the only period showing a figure below 100.

The calculations are based on figures computed in five classifications: food, clothing materials, housing, fuel and lighting, and miscellaneous items. Food dropped from 100 in 1926 to 76 in March and clothing materials from 100 to 83.6. The other classifications all exhibit rises, housing, for example, having increased steadily from 100 to 110.3. The "miscellaneous items" show the sharpest increase, standing at 159.4 as compared with the 1926 average of 100.

Last February shows a general index of 103.5, with food at 80.4, clothing materials at 84, and miscellaneous items at 116.6.

The National Tariff Commission has recorded these things, but no one else—the man in the street, for instance—has noticed them.

BAMBOO SYMBOL IN CHINESE ART

Significance and History Described

Bamboo, symbol of perseverance, uprightness, capacity, humility, charity, firmness, and that "sweet melancholy" so dear to the hearts of Chinese scholars and peasants alike, was the subject of a fascinating lecture, "Bamboo and Bamboo Painting" by ■r. Teng Kwei who addressed mem■rs and guests of the Royal Asiatic Society on Thursday at 5.30 p.m. Rapidly outlining the practical significances of bamboo in the daily life of the Chinese, Mr. Teng observed that, "notwithstanding its importance in practical life, and its influence in intellectual spheres, its greatest inspirations and influences lie in the world of painting, for there it serves, not only as independent subject-matter, but as the link between calligraphy and painting. It is also a point of departure from the ancient and medieval brush-painting to that of the idealistic school still flourishing today.

In his survey of Chinese historic influences upon the art of bamboo painting, the speaker cited the triumphs of creative scholars during the T'ang Dynasty. Then it was that political and military triumphs coupled with social prosperity encouraged hope, broadened attitudes towards life, and presenting leisure for contemplation, stirred scholastic zeal towards initiative and adventure. Particularly did Mr. Teng emphasize the importance of Tao-ism and Buddhism as powers expanding the imaginative scope of artists in that period. With true appreciation of the various forces at work, Mr. Tang stated that "The masters" under such influences, succeeded in achieving something new by the wide and powerful fusion of past and present; objective and subjective; the balanced and the reticent with the eccentric and the expressive." He later commented on the restricting influences of Confucianism.

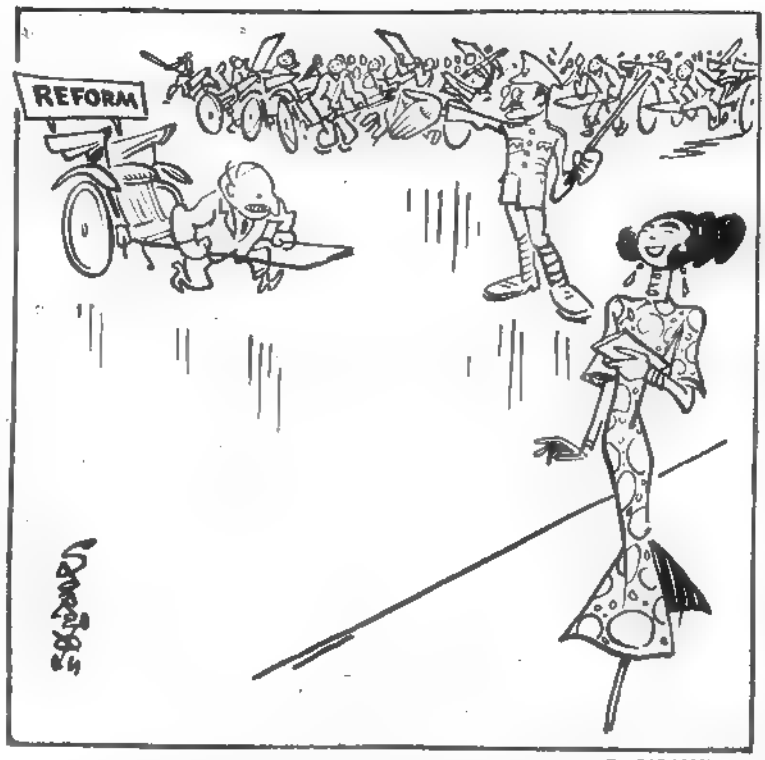
"Although Confucianism contributed much and helped China, keeping her people in place, and cultivating a proper relationship amongst them, it did not encourage artistic creation," he commented. "Art at this period reflects the confucian philosophy, reserved, not free."

Steady Wrist Required

The "ink painting" so vital, so difficult in its technical demands upon the steady brush, of the artist, was developed as a result of the T'ang period he stated. Here, not only the gradation of strokes the gradation of ink values and shades as well as tone qualities, he pointed out. "Among all the subjects the masters painted, bamboo serves as the best illustration, declared Mr. Teng, "It requires the steadiest wrist, the most firm and balanced control to paint successfully its long, straight, yet jointed body, and its flat, knife-like leaves. In painting bamboo, no painter can hide his feeble hand, his wavering brush, or lazy stroke, for its peculiar nature frankly reveals everything and unmasks every trick."

His resumé of each dynasty and its masters discovered Mr. Teng an authority on Chinese art, culture and history. His modesty ■ failing to include any of his own distinctive paintings in his illustrations, a source of regret to the audience, proved him a scholar true to his traditions. Dr. Evan Morgan expressed his appreciation of the lecture on the part of the Society, and called upon Mrs. Florence Ayscough to move a vote of thanks for Mr. Teng's effort on the part of those present. Mrs. Ayscough, in a brief and gracefully worded address, complimented the artist, and observed that "it is at best difficult for the West to appreciate, let alone execute such difficult and exquisite subjects, as do the Chinese."

In response to repeated requests, Mr. Teng promised a possible exhibit of his own paintings in the future.



By SAPAJOU

A NEW RICKSHAW FOR MISS SHANGHAI

MR. MASSEY TAKES RICKSHAW POST

Will Be Chairman of Board Enforcing Reforms

Mr. ■ W. Massey announced his acceptance of the chairmanship of the newly created Rickshaw Board on Friday, at the same time resigning his seat ■ the Municipal Council. The other two members of the Rickshaw Board are Col. M. T. Tchou and Mr. Anson T. Wong.

Mr. Massey, as chairman of the committee which submitted the widely publicized Rickshaw Report to the Council, has gained a thorough insight into the rickshaw situation and will therefore be in a position it ■ held, effectively to carry out the scheme of reform suggested in the report and approved by the Council.

The Board of three will have broad powers to regulate the entire conduct of public and private rickshaws ■ the International Settlement.

The choice of a successor to Mr. Massey in the Council, according to law, rests with the remaining members of the Council.

It is understood the Council contemplates paying a monthly salary of $1,100 ■ the chairman of the Rickshaw Board and $900 each to the two other members.

The creation of the Board was decided upon by the last Council, acting on a recommendation of the joint Traffic and Watch Committee.

Evidence presented during the inquest, at the Public Mortuary, over the bodies of Yang Ping-how, male, and Zung Tsu-chung, female, who were found shot dead in a Weihaiwei Road house on Saturday (Apr. 28) night, all pointed towards Yang having first shot dead the woman and then turned the pistol on himself. Zung had been married to Yang, but later divorced. After hearing all the witnesses, the Procurator returned a verdict that the two deceased had died from bullet wounds.

NEW HOSPITAL FOR CHAPEI

Need Met by Action of Aged Philanthropist

"The long-felt need for a hospital ■ the densely-populated district of Chapei is at last to be met," said the eminent philanthropist Mr. Lo Pa-hong on the occasion of his 60th birthday ■ the course of his reply ■ an eulogistic address delivered by Mayor Wu Te-chen on behalf of the Chinese community of Shanghai.

Sometime ago a group of friends of Mr. Lo Pa-hong, foremost philanthropist of Shanghai, insisted that ■ should not allow his 60th birthday on May 2nd to pass without appropriate celebrations. Mr. Lo drew attention to the national crisis, and in a spirit of humility urged his well-wishers to drop their plans. He finally yielded to persuasion upon the distinct understanding that all the birthday gifts received by him in money or in kind should be set aside as a contribution to the building fund for a new hospital to be put up in Chapei mainly for the benefit of the working classes and the poor, the new institution to be known as the Hospital ■ the Immaculate Heart of Mary.

After benediction Mayor Wu Te-chen before a packed house delivered a touching address of felicitation.

In reply Mr. Lo stressed his own unworthiness of the praises conferred upon him by the Mayor and by his friends.

"My only excuse for my birthday celebrations is that the gifts will be all used for the new hospital at Chapei. We have 30 mow of land acquired ten years ago but never used on account of lack of funds. My experience enables me to say that 'The family with a record of good deeds will be blessed with causes for rejoicing."

MEMORIAL FOR MRS. CUNNINGHAM

A special visit to the Yih Garden, Kiangwan, was paid by the American Consul General, Mr. E. S. Cunningham, on Tuesday (May 1) morning, accompanied by Dr. Anne Walter Fearn, Vice-President, and Mr. K. I. Wang, Secretary, of the National Child Welfare Association of China, Dr. F. C. Yen, Superintendent of the Red Cross General Hospital and other distinguished guests. Part of this garden, which contains an area of 80 mow, and is owned by Mr. Yeh Tse-ching, Jr., has been assigned as a site for the erection of a Child Welfare Sanitarium by the Executive Committee of the N.C.W.A. in memory of the late Mrs. Cunningham, who was one of the most active committee members on their Board.

THE OBSERVANCE OF LABOUR DAY

Holiday Given 20,000 Workers

In observance ■ International Labour Day, some 20,000 workers of various local leading industrial concerns suspended work on Tuesday (May 1), half of the number being ■ the employ of concerns in the Settlement.

Approximately 150 representatives of the various labour unions attended a commemoration meeting held under the auspices of the General Labour Union at its offices, 117 Foh You Road, Nantao, in the morning. After the usual Kuomintang ceremonies, speeches dwelling on the significance of the International Labour Day were given.

Mr. Chu Hsueh-fan, an executive member, who presided, made a brief report on the history of the day. He said the Chicago labourers, in an effort to better the treatment to labourers, launched a movement on October 7, 1886. Their fight for the three "eight-hours" system did not meet with success until May 1 the following year. While advocating the strict enforcement of the system, Mr. Chu advised the labourers ■ co-operate with the employers and increase the power of production.

Military Training

The Labour Union also issued a circular to the workers, advising them to emulate the workers in Europe and America by resisting the oppression of capitalists, encouraging them to work harder ■ order to increase China's industrial production, and lastly reminding them of the national crisis since the outbreak of the Mukden Incident and advising them to undergo military training.

It was also made known that day that the Union had decided to apply to the Central Executive Committee of the Kuomintang for permission to establish a Military Training Section in the Union so as to enable all labourers to receive military training during their leisure hours.

Police authorities took precautionary measures against possible disturbances by reactionary elements. Nothing untoward happened during the day.

Fogs such as Shanghai usually gets would be termed mere mists by visitors from London, inured by long experience to the yellow, opaque clouds which periodically grip that city, but Friday's efforts by the Weatherman would stand comparison with a mild form of London fog.

Travellers to China will have to submit to examination concerning their supply of tobacco, for by order of the Government, passengers from abroad are permitted to bring into China free of duty not more than 25 cigars, 200 cigarettes, and half pound of tobacco.

GERMAN NATIONAL DAY KEPT

Elaborate Ceremonies by Local Community

Impressive flag-raising ceremonies before the German Consulate inaugurated the first "National German Peoples' Holiday" to be observed in Shanghai. May Day, proclaimed a "Peoples' Day" by law last February by the German Reich, began for the German colony here at 8 a.m. on Tuesday (May 1) when the national flags, the familiar official black, white and red barred emblem bearing the German Eagle on a white ground, and the equally familiar Swastika flag, were borne into the Consulate grounds on Whangpoo Road by Hitler Youths, to the tune of the Hohenfriedberger March. Mr. R. C. W. Behrends, acting consul-general, sounded the keynote of the day—nationalism and patriotism—in his brief address. Through the co-operation of the Harbour Master and the River Police, no steamboat whistles interrupted the ceremonies.

The general invitation to all members of the German community issued by Mr. Behrends a few days ago brought an enthusiastic response, and ■ consequence, Mr. Behrends faced a crowd of some dimensions when he spoke. The two flags, raised slightly on their respective casts, were unfurled, and as they were raised, Mr. Behrends addressed them as follows: "You, Black, White and Red Flag, carry our greetings to the Fatherland—and you, Swastika Flag, tell our homeland that again we pledge ourselves to be faithful to our Fatherland to the death. Homeland! Fatherland! Germany! Hail! Hail! Hail!"

Youths Salute Flag

As he spoke, the Hitler Youths, organized last October in Shanghai, stood at attention and at salute facing him and the group of official representatives of German organizations. Clad in khaki uniform, their caps bearing the insignia of the swastika, they symbolised the youngest German Nationalists, including girls and boys from the ages of 10 to 18. The S.A., (organized sport groups), stood on the consul's right, while at his left were the B.D.M., (the organized women's group), including girls above 18. All were surrounded by members of the German community who sang the German national anthem with great spirit immediately at the conclusion of the flag-raising proper. The party anthem "Das Horst Wessel—Lied", now co-ordinated with the former national anthem as is the swastika flag with the national flag, concluded ■ the brief services.

Standing with Mr. Behrend in the consulate gallery during the service were Mr. J. Wiedmann, acting president of the German community; Mr. C. Gadow, president of the German Garden Club; Mr. G. E. Schink, leader of the German National-Socialist-Labour Party for China and Japan; Capt. Th. Hannig, local leader of the N.S.D.A.P., which is the popular designation of the present German party; Mr. E. Mirow, chairman of the committee of the German Evangelical Church; Mr. E. Brannecke, local leader of the Hitler Youths; Mr. F. Reiber, president of the German Club; Mrs. S. Wiedmann, local leader of the N.S.D.A.P. Women's organization; Mrs. O. Roehrecke, president of the German Women's Benevolent Society; Mr. G. Boolsen, president of the German Chamber of Commerce, and Dr. W. Weber, director of the Kaiser Wilhelm Schule.

Sports at School

At the conclusion of the service, the Hitler Youths, bearing the two flags, filed out all present saluting. Music for the occasion, and later at the Kaiser Wilhelm Schule, where "■. A." games and competitions were held, was by a band composed of part of the Municipal Orchestra led by Mr. Schroader. From 9 until noon, German schoolboys whose excellence in sports is now a compulsory part of their school curriculum, competed for honours. Those taking first places will be presented with diplomas signed by the president of the Reich in order that they, half a world away from the Fatherland, may have recognition from their own national leaders.

Repeatedly in the speeches marking the "National Celebration," the significance of May 1 was emphasized as definitely commemorating the nationalization of labour as an integral factor of German life to-day, the veritable cornerstone of national life.

Dr. Benzion H. Shein, emissary of the World's Zionist Organization, was introduced to the members of the Shanghai Rotary Club, on the occasion of its usual weekly tiffin meeting, held in the Metropole Hotel on Thursday, by Mr. M. S. Bloch, president of the Shanghai Jewish club, announcing his subject as "Present-day Palestine, and the Jawish movement for settlement there."

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